



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2024 Version B for STA 235H - DATA SCI FOR BUSN APPS: HON (05205) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2024**

Courses Audience: **25**

Responses Received: **24**

Response Ratio: **96.0%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

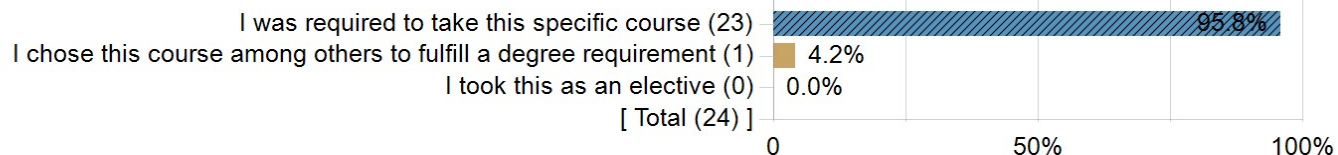
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

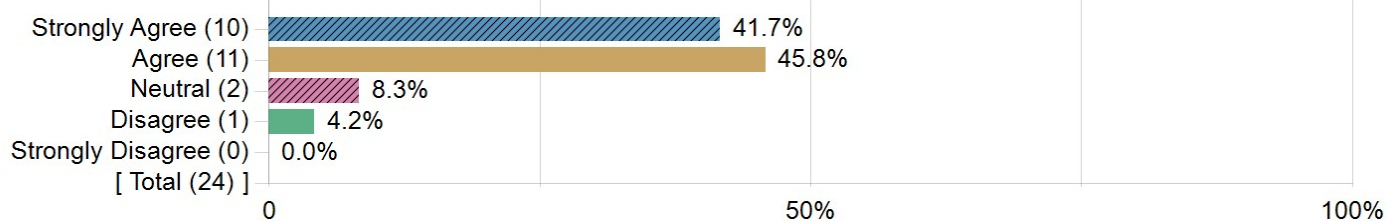
Creation Date: **Thursday, January 23, 2025**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?

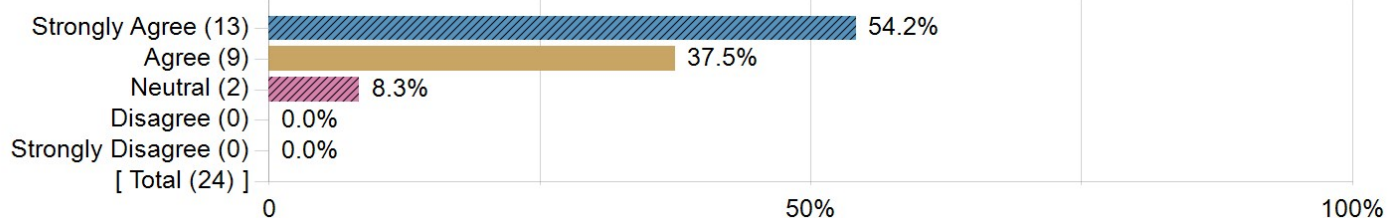


During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



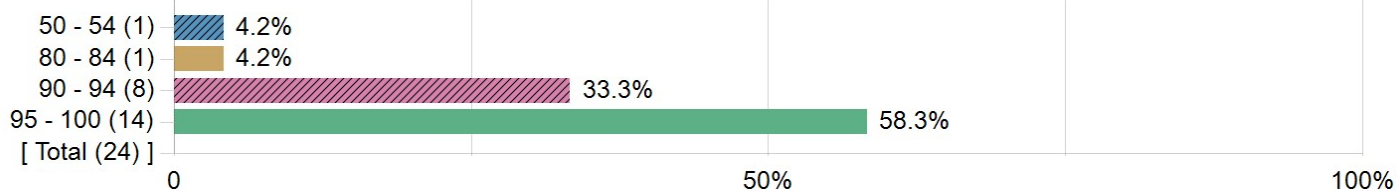
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.25

The course was well organized.



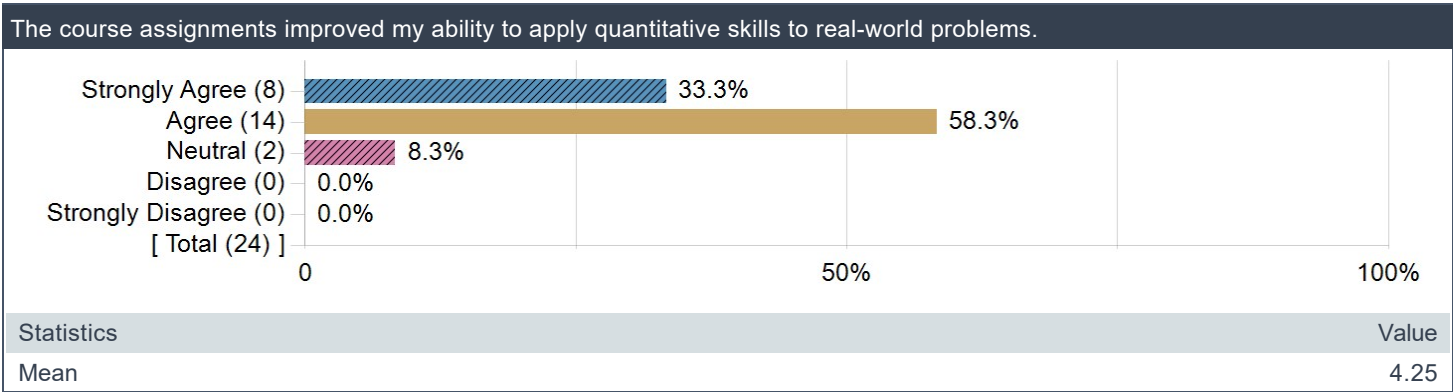
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.46

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



Statistics	Value
Mean	93.08

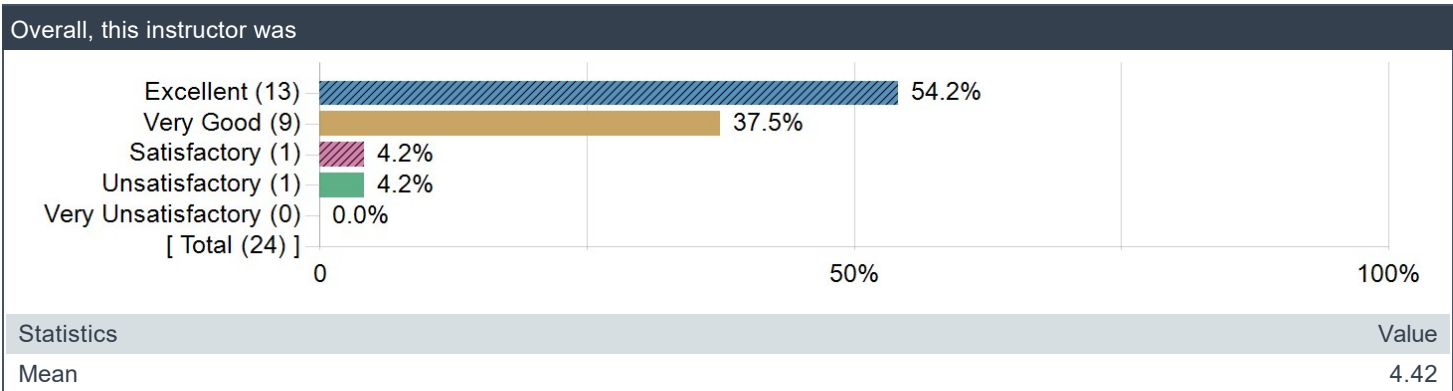
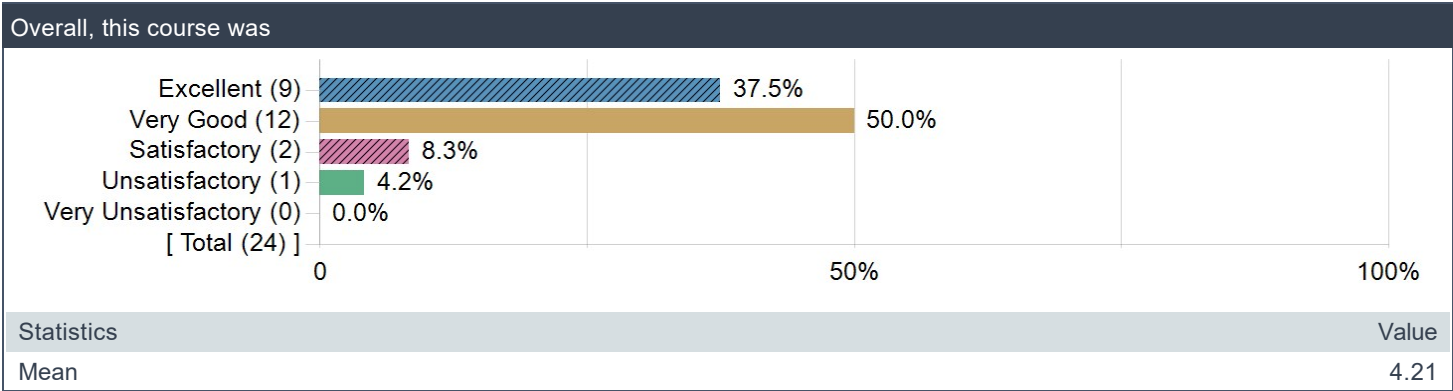
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



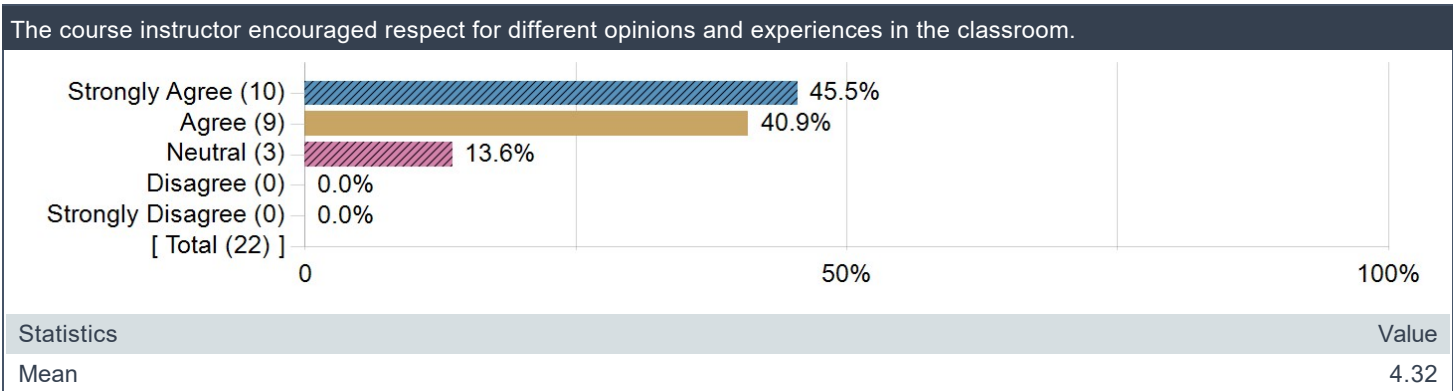
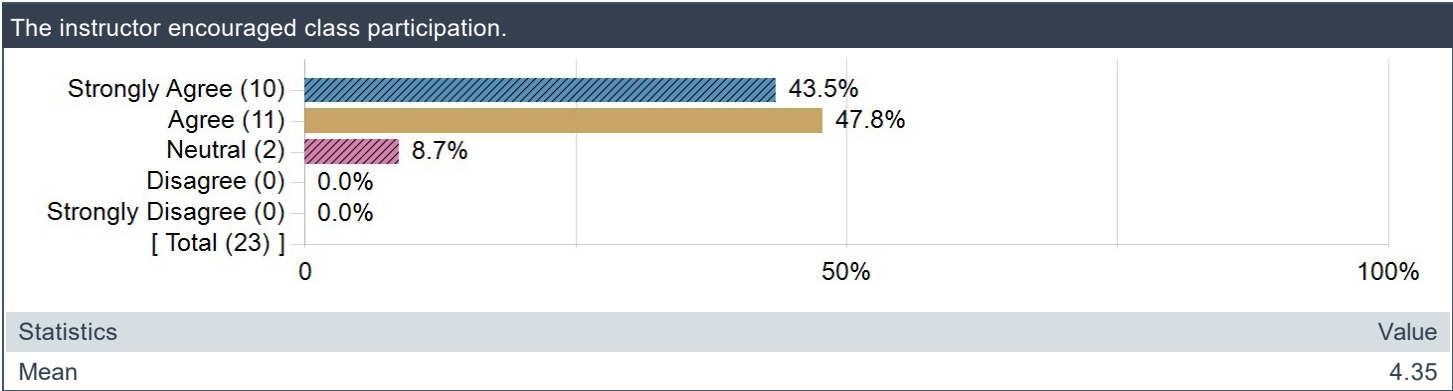
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	50.0%	45.8%	4.2%	0.0%	0.0%	24	4.46
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	66.7%	25.0%	8.3%	0.0%	0.0%	24	4.58
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	45.8%	50.0%	0.0%	4.2%	0.0%	24	4.38
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	41.7%	41.7%	8.3%	0.0%	8.3%	24	4.08
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	50.0%	45.8%	4.2%	0.0%	0.0%	24	4.46

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Helpful KCs. Good teaching, well-paced
The lecture slides were well put together and the homeworks helped gain an understanding.
Learning R Studio through lectures
The examples and slides were always very helpful, organized, and on topic. I thought they were also the perfect level of concision to help.
Practicing R coding in class was extremely helpful.
Doing code during actual class time
The homework assignments gave me a risk-free environment to practice skills I had learned in class.
The knowledge checks and homework assignments
Open access to homework assignments, participation, and other submissions were very helpful for studying for the midterm and final.
I think the KCs and Homework's were very helpful, along with having the class scripts on canvas.
Professor Bolfarine is very helpful and always breaks concepts down into simple pieces.
Organized lecture slides and R scripts
The canvas page, posted slides, and the assignments were set up to help me learn the material quickly and well.
The Knowledge Checks after each class were very helpful, as well as the step-by-step instructions and code commenting.
Very structured Canvas and course, constantly had resources on hand.
Deeper explanations of subjects on the white board
The knowledge checks and homework were helpful.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Tests were harder.
The tests were hard but everything was manageable.
The Homeworks
I think that marrying the R side to the math side was somewhat a little tricky but overall not bad.
More conceptual aspects of the course were challenging and could have benefited from more in depth explanations.
Everything learned after the midterm —> more practice questions/assignments would have been helpful
The thing I found the most challenging was maintaining focus for an hour and 45 minutes. Perhaps the class could be divided into two classes per week rather than one.
That it was very early
Lectures could be covered at a quicker pace. It feels like not a lot of material is covered each session despite the longer class time.
The midterm was a little difficult for me because some of the questions weren't gone over as much in class, but that was also my bad for not studying those sections as much.
Its often hard to remember all of the specific code structures.
The lectures dragged on a bit at times, though they were easy to digest.
Having an 8am section is difficult. It was the only one that fit into my schedule, but no one should have a 2 hour class at 8am.
Lectures could stand to be more engaging rather than just various questions with clear answers that didn't really need to be questions. It's hard to feel as if attending the lectures is acutally that useful.
Differentiating between models because it made it harder to interpret. More practice materials for exams
Sometimes the homework was a little long, but having the r-script after the homework is submitted would be helpful.

